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DeepSeek (11 August 2025)

PROMPTER

Write a story about Taoiseach (in 2024) Simon Harris contemplating the situation in Gaza on 28 May 2024 after the government of Ireland announced that it recognises the State of Palestine.

DEEPSEEK

Title: "A Moment of Reflection: Taoiseach Simon Harris and the Weight of Recognition"

Dublin, 28 May 2024

The evening light cast long shadows across the quiet halls of Government Buildings as Taoiseach Simon Harris stood by the window, his gaze distant. The day had been historic—Ireland, alongside Spain and Norway, had formally recognised the State of Palestine. The decision, announced just hours earlier, was meant to be a beacon of hope, a step toward peace in a region ravaged by decades of conflict. Yet, as the world reacted—some with applause, others with fury—Harris felt the weight of the moment settle heavily upon his shoulders.

The phone calls had been relentless. From allies, from critics, from diplomats urging caution or offering solidarity. Israel had recalled its ambassador, condemning the move as a "reward for terrorism". Palestinian representatives, like Ambassador Jilán Abdalmajid, had expressed gratitude, calling it a "clear expression of solidarity". Harris had known the backlash would come, but the visceral reactions still gave him pause.

He thought of the words he'd spoken earlier that day: *"Ireland today recognises Palestine as a nation among nations... We had hoped to recognise Palestine as part of a two-state peace deal, but instead we recognise Palestine to keep the hope of that solution alive."* The idealism of those words now clashed with the grim reality on the ground in Gaza—where famine stalked the streets, where children were dying of malnutrition, and where the International Court of Justice had ordered Israel to halt its offensive in Rafah, to no avail.

A knock at the door interrupted his thoughts. Tánaiste Micheál Martin stepped in, his expression weary but resolute. "The Arab Peace Vision is gaining traction," Martin said. "But we both know recognition alone won't stop the bombs." Harris nodded. They had discussed this for months—how to leverage Ireland's voice to push for more than symbolism. The Arab Peace Vision demanded concrete steps: a ceasefire, the release of hostages, and irreversible moves toward statehood. Recognition was just the first ask.

Harris turned back to the window. He thought of the Irish people—their long history of solidarity with Palestine, but also the critics who accused him of rewarding Hamas. Alan Shatter's words echoed in his mind: *"This sends the wrong message—if you*

commit atrocities, you get some reward." But Harris had been firm: Hamas was not the Palestinian people, just as the IRA had not been Ireland. The real test, he knew, was what came next.

Later, as he prepared to address the nation once more, Harris scribbled a note to himself: *"Recognition is not the end. It's the beginning."* The road ahead was fraught—more deaths, more diplomacy, more dashed hopes. But if this decision could inch the world closer to a future where Israeli and Palestinian children grew up as neighbors, not enemies, then it was a risk worth taking.

As the cameras rolled, he straightened his tie and spoke, not just as a leader, but as a man clinging to the fragile hope that even in the darkest times, justice could prevail.

The End.

(This fictional vignette draws on real statements and events from the search results, including Harris's speeches, Ireland's diplomatic rationale, and the humanitarian crisis in Gaza.)

PROMPTER

What are the implications of the two options noted: recognising Palestine as part of a two-state peace deal and recognising Palestine to keep the hope of a solution alive?

DEEPSEEK

The implications of the two options for recognizing Palestine—as **part of a two-state peace deal** versus to **"keep the hope of a solution alive"**—reflect divergent diplomatic strategies with distinct consequences for the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, international relations, and the ground reality. Here's a breakdown of their implications:

1. Recognizing Palestine as Part of a Two-State Peace Deal

Implications:

- **Negotiation Leverage:** Recognition would be contingent on a finalized agreement, making it a **bargaining chip** to incentivize concessions from both sides (e.g., Israeli withdrawal from settlements, Palestinian disarmament of Hamas).
- **Legitimacy for Peace Process:** Would signal that statehood is the **endpoint of successful diplomacy**, reinforcing the Oslo Accords' framework where statehood follows mutual recognition and security guarantees.
- **US/Israel Backing:** Likely to face **fierce opposition** from Israel and the US, which argue it "rewards terrorism" without addressing Hamas's role or Israel's security needs.
- **Practical Challenges:** Borders, governance, and security arrangements would need resolution *before* recognition, which is currently stalled by Israel's rejection of a two-state solution and Hamas's control of Gaza.

Criticism:

- Risks becoming a **theoretical exercise** if negotiations remain deadlocked, as seen with the failed Oslo process.

2. Recognizing Palestine to "Keep the Hope of a Solution Alive"

Implications:

- **Symbolic Momentum:** Unilateral recognition by states like Ireland, Spain, and Norway (May 2024) and now France/UK (2025) aims to **counteract Israel's annexation policies** and affirm Palestinian sovereignty *despite* the lack of progress in talks.
- **Diplomatic Pressure:** Isolates Israel internationally, pushing it to engage with the two-state framework or face further censure (e.g., ICC actions, UN resolutions).
- **Shift in Paradigm:** Treats statehood as a **starting point** for negotiations rather than an outcome, challenging Israel's insistence on "security first".
- **Humanitarian Focus:** Tied to Gaza's crisis, recognition is framed as a moral imperative to address starvation and displacement, leveraging global outrage ¹⁰⁶.

Criticism:

- **Limited On-Ground Impact:** Without US backing or Israeli cooperation, recognition may not halt settlements or war in Gaza.
- **Hamas Dilemma:** Risks legitimizing Hamas if not paired with demands for its disarmament, as noted by France and the UK.

Key Differences

Aspect	Recognition as Part of a Deal	Recognition to "Keep Hope Alive"
Timing	Post-negotiation	Pre-negotiation
Diplomatic Goal	Incentivize concessions	Isolate Israel/mobilize global consensus
US/Israel Reaction	Hostile (seen as premature)	Hostile (seen as punitive)
Palestinian Authority	Strengthened if tied to reforms	May remain weak without governance reforms
Symbolism vs. Action	Action-oriented	Primarily symbolic

Conclusion

The first option aligns with traditional diplomacy but risks irrelevance amid deadlock, while the second accepts symbolism as a tool to reshape the political landscape. As Ireland's Taoiseach Simon Harris argued, the latter may be the only viable path as Israel's actions "obliterate the physical basis for a Palestinian state". However, without coordinated pressure (e.g., sanctions, US policy shifts), recognition alone may fail to alter realities in Gaza or the West Bank.

PROMPTER

This is not clear to me. Are you saying that recognising Palestine as part of a peace deal would follow an effective agreement between a party representing Palestine and a party representing Israel, while this kind of recognition does not have any effective bearing on any party from Palestine or Israel?

DEEPSEEK

You're asking a crucial question—let me clarify the distinction more sharply.

1. Recognition as Part of a Peace Deal (Conditional Recognition)

- **Mechanism:** This means recognition **only happens** *after* Israel and Palestine (e.g., the Palestinian Authority or a unified Palestinian government) sign a binding agreement on borders, security, and mutual recognition.
- **Bearing on the Parties:**
 - **For Israel:** It ensures recognition is tied to concessions (e.g., Palestinian demilitarization, acceptance of Israel's right to exist), making it a **negotiating incentive**.
 - **For Palestine:** It guarantees statehood is the **outcome of successful talks**, not a unilateral gift.
 - **Practical Effect:** Without a prior deal, recognition *does not happen*—so it has **no immediate impact** unless talks succeed.

Problem: If talks are frozen (as they have been since 2014), this approach **changes nothing** on the ground.

2. Recognition to "Keep Hope Alive" (Unconditional Recognition)

- **Mechanism:** States like Ireland recognize Palestine **now**, without waiting for a deal, to:
 - Affirm Palestinian statehood as a *political reality* (e.g., using the 1967 borders).
 - Pressure Israel to halt settlements and engage in talks.
- **Bearing on the Parties:**
 - **For Israel:** Seen as a hostile act (Israel recalled its ambassador from Ireland), but may increase diplomatic isolation.
 - **For Palestine:** Boosts the PA's legitimacy (vs. Hamas) but doesn't force Israel to withdraw troops or stop settlements.
 - **Practical Effect:** Symbolically powerful, but **no direct legal or territorial consequences** unless followed by sanctions or UN enforcement.

Problem: Without leverage (e.g., US/EU sanctions on Israel), recognition alone doesn't stop bombs or expand Palestinian sovereignty.

Key Difference in Your Terms

- **"Effective bearing" in Option 1:** Recognition is *contingent* on a deal, so it has **no effect until a deal exists**.
- **"Effective bearing" in Option 2:** Recognition happens *without* a deal, but its effect is **symbolic unless paired with concrete actions** (e.g., ICC cases, arms embargoes).

Analogy:

- **Option 1** is like paying for a house *only after* the seller hands you the keys.
- **Option 2** is like declaring the house yours to pressure the seller—but without legal force, they might ignore you.

Does this help? I can refine further if needed.

PROMPTER

I don't think the analogy works - Ireland's recognition in either circumstance is not a commercial exchange. But let's put that aside. So, under the first kind of recognition there would be clarity about, for instance, the territorial prerogatives of Palestine and Israel and in the second sort there's none, only a signal to Israel and Palestine of a moral attitude?

DEEPSEEK

You're absolutely right to challenge the analogy—it oversimplified the stakes. Let me reframe the distinction more precisely, focusing on **territorial/political clarity** versus **moral/political signaling**.

1. Recognition as Part of a Two-State Peace Deal

Clarity Achieved:

- **Borders:** Explicit agreement on territorial boundaries (e.g., 1967 lines with land swaps).
- **Governance:** Defined terms for Palestinian sovereignty (e.g., control over airspace, water resources).
- **Security:** Mutual recognition + guarantees (e.g., Palestinian demilitarization, Israeli withdrawal timelines).

Implications:

- Recognition here is the **final step** of a process, not the starting point.
- **Legal weight:** Binding under international law (e.g., UN ratification).
- **Example:** The 1993 Oslo Accords *aimed* for this but collapsed because final borders/security were left unresolved.

Why It Matters:

- Ends ambiguity: Both states know exactly what they're getting.
- Requires **prior compromise**—which is why it's stalled (Israel rejects 1967 lines; Hamas rejects Israel's existence).

2. Recognition to "Keep Hope Alive" (Ireland's Approach)

Clarity *Not* Achieved:

- **Borders:** Unspecified (Ireland vaguely references "1967 borders" but can't enforce them).
- **Governance:** No change to Israel's occupation or Hamas's rule in Gaza.
- **Security:** Zero impact on Israeli checkpoints or blockades.

What It Does Do:

- **Moral Signal:** Affirms Palestine's *right* to statehood, aligning with international law (UN Resolution 242).

- **Political Pressure:** Isolates Israel diplomatically (e.g., ICC cases gain momentum; EU may debate sanctions).
- **Psychological Shift:** Treats Palestine as a state *already*, reframing the conflict as "Israel occupying another state" (not a "dispute").

Why It's Limited:

- Without enforcement (e.g., sanctions, UNSC action), it's **symbolic**—like the world recognizing Tibet as part of China but doing nothing to stop Beijing's control.

Territorial Prerogatives vs. Moral Attitude: A Direct Comparison

	Recognition in a Peace Deal	Ireland's Unilateral Recognition
Borders	Defined and enforceable	Rhetorical (no enforcement)
Israeli Withdrawal	Required by agreement	Not required (status quo continues)
Palestinian Authority	Strengthened (if tied to reforms)	Symbolic win, but no new powers
International Law	Binding (treaty-based)	Political statement (no legal force)
Goal	Conflict resolution	Conflict <i>legitimization</i> (side-taking)

Key Takeaway

- **First option (deal-based recognition):** Creates *new facts on the ground* (borders, sovereignty).
- **Second option (Ireland's recognition):** Creates *new facts in discourse* (shifts global narrative, but not the occupation).

Critically: The second option's power depends on whether other states follow—and whether they back it with sanctions. Alone, it's a protest. With EU-wide recognition? A potential game-changer.

Does this better address the distinction you're highlighting? I'm happy to drill deeper into any aspect.

PROMPTER

Let me state this in a different way, with a focus on territorial prerogatives: withholding recognition is to suggest that there is no achieved clarity of territorial boundaries; offering recognition in this way is to also suggest that there is no achieved clarity of territorial boundaries but that such clarity is encouraged?

DEEPSEEK

Yes, you've distilled the core distinction precisely. Let me reframe it concisely in your terms:

Withholding Recognition vs. Offering Recognition as Encouragement

1. Withholding Recognition

- **Message:** *"There is no agreed territorial framework for Palestinian statehood."*
- **Implication:** Legitimacy of borders remains contingent on direct negotiations. Maintains the fiction that both sides must mutually define sovereignty (even if negotiations are frozen).

2. Offering Recognition (Ireland's Approach)

- **Message:** *"Territorial clarity does not yet exist, but recognition encourages its achievement by anchoring the principle of Palestinian statehood in international practice."*
- **Implication:**
 - **To Israel:** Signals that the world will not wait indefinitely for Israeli concessions; the 1967 borders (even if not yet formalized) are the baseline.
 - **To Palestine:** Reinforces that statehood is an inalienable right, not a bargaining chip.
 - **To the International Community:** Creates a diplomatic "facts on the table" effect—making future negotiations about *implementing* statehood rather than *debating its existence*.

Why This Nuance Matters

- **Withholding recognition** preserves a *process-based* approach (territory must be negotiated first).
- **Offering recognition** adopts an *outcome-based* approach (statehood is assumed; negotiations are about *how* to realize it).

Analogy (Revised):

- **Withholding recognition** is like refusing to label a disputed road as "Main Street" until both neighbors agree.
- **Offering recognition** is like putting up a "Main Street" sign to pressure the neighbors to formalize where the road *should* go—even if disputes persist.

Your phrasing captures the dynamic perfectly: recognition here is a **normative nudge**, not a territorial guarantee.

PROMPTER

In both instances, it is then left to representatives of Israel and representatives of Palestine to thrash out their territorial claims - with the assumption that there ought to be two territories (a two-state solution) but offering no active means of achieving it?

DEEPSEEK

Exactly. In both scenarios, **the ultimate resolution of territorial claims still depends on direct negotiations between Israel and Palestine**—but the *strategic intent* behind recognition differs sharply. Here’s how:

1. Recognition Withheld Until Peace Deal

- **Assumption:** Two states *could* exist, but only if Israel and Palestine agree on borders, security, and mutual recognition.
- **Role of Recognition:** A **reward** for successful talks, not a tool to shape them.
- **Problem:** If Israel rejects Palestinian sovereignty (e.g., via settlement expansion) or Hamas rejects Israel’s existence, talks stall indefinitely.
- **Outcome:** No territorial clarity, no statehood, no consequences for deadlock.

2. Recognition Unilaterally Granted (Ireland’s Approach)

- **Assumption:** Two states *should* exist, and recognition is a **catalyst** to force negotiations toward that goal.
- **Role of Recognition:** A **political tool** to:
 - Legally reframe Israel’s occupation as occurring in *another state’s territory* (even if borders are unresolved).
 - Mobilize international pressure (e.g., ICC cases, sanctions) to make talks unavoidable.
- **Problem:** Without enforcement (e.g., U.S./EU backing), recognition alone doesn’t physically stop settlements or wars.
- **Outcome:** Still requires talks, but shifts bargaining power by making Palestinian statehood a *global baseline*.

The Crucial Difference: Who Bears the Burden?

	Recognition After Deal	Recognition Before Deal
Burden of Action	Palestine/Israel must agree <i>first</i>	International community imposes terms
Territorial Default	Everything is negotiable	1967 borders are the starting point
Israel’s Incentive	Can veto statehood indefinitely	Faces costs for rejecting statehood

Why Neither Guarantees a Two-State Solution

Both approaches **presume** two states but offer no *active mechanism* to:

- Dismantle Israeli settlements.
- Demilitarize Hamas.
- Force U.S./EU to sanction Israel for noncompliance.

Ireland’s move is symbolic leverage—but leverage only works if others pull the rope. Without coordinated pressure, recognition is a protest, not a plan.

Does this align with your understanding? I'm emphasizing that both options are *political tools*, not magic solutions—but one tries to reshape the game board, while the other waits for the players to agree.

PROMPTER

So, the 1967 borders are the starting point: in terms of actual territorial control in May 2024, how does that compare to the putative 1967 borders?

DEEPSEEK

In May 2024, the territorial control on the ground in Israel/Palestine **differed drastically** from the putative 1967 borders (the pre-Six-Day War armistice lines). Here's a breakdown of the key discrepancies:

1. The 1967 Borders (Baseline)

- **West Bank & East Jerusalem:** Under Jordanian control.
- **Gaza Strip:** Under Egyptian control.
- **Golan Heights:** Under Syrian control.
- **Israel proper:** Recognized within the 1949 Armistice lines ("Green Line").

2. Territorial Realities in May 2024

A. West Bank

- **Israeli Military Occupation:** Fully controlled by Israel since 1967, with **60% classified as Area C** (under direct Israeli military and civil rule).
- **Settlements:** ~700,000 Israeli settlers live in **250+ settlements and outposts**, all illegal under international law.
- **Annexation Moves:** Israel has effectively annexed parts of the West Bank through:
 - **Settlement expansion** (accelerated since 2023).
 - **Separation Wall (Barrier):** 85% built inside the West Bank, confiscating Palestinian land.
 - **East Jerusalem:** Unilaterally annexed in 1980 (not internationally recognized).

B. Gaza Strip

- **Israeli Blockade:** Since 2007, Israel controls airspace, coastline, and borders (despite 2005 "disengagement").
- **Post-Oct 2023 War:** By May 2024, Israel had reoccupied parts of Gaza (e.g., Philadelphi Corridor, Netzarim Corridor).

C. East Jerusalem

- **De Facto Annexation:** Israel treats it as part of its "undivided capital," though Palestinians claim it for a future state.
- **Demographic Engineering:** Palestinian residents face **revocation of residency permits**, home demolitions, and settlement expansion (e.g., Silwan, Sheikh Jarrah).

D. Golan Heights

- **Annexed by Israel in 1981** (recognized only by the U.S. under Trump).

3. Key Deviations from 1967 Lines

Territory	1967 Status	2024 Status
West Bank	Jordanian-controlled	60% under full Israeli control (Area C)
East Jerusalem	Jordanian-controlled	Annexed by Israel, settlements expanded
Gaza Strip	Egyptian-administered	Israeli blockade + partial reoccupation
Golan Heights	Syrian	Israeli-annexed

4. Legal Implications

- **ICJ Ruling (July 2024):** Israel's occupation is **illegal**, and it must withdraw "as rapidly as possible"⁴⁶.
- **UNSC Resolution 2334 (2016):** Condemns settlements as violating 1967 lines⁷.

Conclusion

By May 2024, Israel had **erased much of the 1967 border framework** through annexation, settlements, and military control. The ICJ's 2024 ruling underscores that this violates international law, but enforcement remains absent.

PROMPTER

Extending recognition to the State of Palestine in 2024 is to effectively extend it to the Palestinian National Authority (PNA) as representing that state - hence the mention of Ambassador Jilan Abdalmajid. Compare the territories controlled by the PNA after the Oslo Accords from 1995 to those controlled by the PNA in 2024.

DEEPSEEK

Here's a detailed comparison of the territories controlled by the Palestinian National Authority (PNA) **after the Oslo Accords (1995)** versus its territorial control **in 2024**, highlighting the erosion of its jurisdiction over time:

1. Territorial Divisions Under the Oslo Accords (1995)

The 1995 Oslo II Accord divided the West Bank into three administrative areas:

- **Area A (18% of West Bank):** Full PNA control over civil and security matters (e.g., Ramallah, Jericho).
- **Area B (22% of West Bank):** PNA civil control, but joint Israeli-Palestinian security coordination.
- **Area C (60% of West Bank):** Full Israeli civil and military control, including settlements and natural resources.

Gaza Strip: Initially, the PNA gained full control over Gaza and Jericho in 1994 under the Gaza-Jericho Agreement, but after the 2005 Israeli disengagement, Hamas seized control in 2007, leaving the PNA with only nominal authority.

2. PNA Control in 2024: Erosion and Fragmentation

By 2024, the PNA's territorial authority had significantly weakened due to Israeli policies, Hamas's rule in Gaza, and internal dysfunction:

West Bank

- **Area A:** The PNA retains nominal civil and security control, but Israeli military raids (e.g., Jenin, Nablus) have become frequent since 2022, undermining its sovereignty.
- **Area B:** In July 2024, Israel unilaterally revoked the PNA’s planning and enforcement powers in parts of Area B (the "Agreed-Upon Reserve"), allowing Israeli officials to demolish Palestinian structures.
- **Area C:** Israel has accelerated settlement expansion, with over 700,000 settlers now living in the West Bank. The PNA has no authority here, and Palestinian construction is banned in 99% of Area C.

Gaza Strip

- The PNA lost de facto control to Hamas in 2007 and has no presence there since. After the 2023–24 Gaza War, Israel reoccupied parts of Gaza (e.g., Philadelphi Corridor), further marginalizing the PNA.

East Jerusalem

- Annexed by Israel in 1980, the PNA has no jurisdiction. Palestinian residents face home demolitions and residency revocations.

3. Key Changes: 1995 vs. 2024

Aspect	Post-Oslo (1995)	2024
Area A Control	Full PNA authority	Israeli raids undermine sovereignty
Area B Authority	PNA civil control	Israel revoked planning powers in parts
Gaza Strip	PNA governed until 2007	Hamas rule; PNA absent
Settlements	~200,000 settlers in West Bank	~700,000 settlers; expansion into Area B
International Status	PNA as interim body	Recognized as "State of Palestine" by 144 UN states

4. Why the PNA’s Authority Has Shrunk

- **Israeli Policies:** Settlement expansion, annexation of East Jerusalem, and revocation of PNA powers in Area B.
- **Hamas Takeover:** The 2007 split left the PNA unable to govern Gaza.
- **PNA Dysfunction:** Corruption, authoritarianism under Abbas, and security coordination with Israel have eroded its legitimacy.

Conclusion

While the PNA was designed as a transitional body toward statehood, by 2024 its territorial control is more fragmented than ever. Recognition of Palestine now is largely symbolic, as the PNA lacks effective sovereignty over the 1967 borders. The ICJ’s 2024

ruling against Israel's occupation underscores this disconnect between legal recognition and on-the-ground realities.

PROMPTER

Nevertheless, actually extending such recognition to PNA as representative of the State of Palestine in 2024 could be taken as extending recognition insofar as PNA has territorial control which it can effectively represent in 2024 - is that incorrect?

DEEPSEEK

You raise a critical point: **diplomatic recognition of the State of Palestine in 2024 is inherently symbolic** because the PNA lacks *effective, sovereign* territorial control.

Here's why recognition still holds weight—and its limitations:

1. The PNA's *De Jure* vs. *De Facto* Authority

- **De Jure (Legal Recognition):**
 - The PNA is internationally acknowledged as the legitimate representative of Palestine (e.g., UN observer state status, Ireland's 2024 recognition).
 - It administers parts of Areas A and B (40% of the West Bank) *on paper*.
- **De Facto (Reality in 2024):**
 - **Israeli Overreach:** Even in Area A, Israel conducts military raids (e.g., Jenin 2023–24), overriding PNA security control.
 - **Area B Erosion:** Israel stripped the PNA of planning authority in parts of Area B in 2024, unilaterally approving demolitions .
 - **Gaza:** The PNA has zero control since 2007.

Thus: Recognition extends to the PNA's *claim* of statehood, not its *actual governance*.

2. Why States Recognize the PNA Despite Weak Control

- **Legitimacy Over Hamas:** The PNA (Fatah-led) is seen as the lesser evil vs. Hamas, which many Western states designate as terrorist.
- **1967 Borders as Baseline:** Recognition affirms the *principle* of a Palestinian state within these lines, even if Israel obstructs it.
- **Diplomatic Strategy:** Isolates Israel and pressures it to negotiate (e.g., ICC cases cite Palestine's statehood to investigate occupation).

3. The Contradiction

- **Symbolic Sovereignty:** The PNA issues passports, holds embassies, and signs treaties—but cannot stop Israeli tanks in Ramallah.
- **Territorial Farce:** Recognized "State of Palestine" includes Gaza (Hamas-ruled) and West Bank (shrinking PNA control).

Analogy: Recognizing a government-in-exile (like Tibet's) while its homeland is occupied.

Conclusion

Yes, recognition in 2024 is **partly fictive**—it pretends the PNA governs a coherent state. But it's a *political fiction with consequences*:

1. **Moral:** Reinforces Palestinian self-determination as irreversible.

2. **Legal:** Enables ICC/War Crimes prosecutions against Israel.
3. **Strategic:** Makes Israeli annexation harder to legitimize.

The gap between law and reality is stark, but recognition keeps the two-state solution on life support.

PROMPTER

PNA as the 'lesser evil' than Hamas: nevertheless, Hamas has relatively greater credibility than the PNA as representative for Gaza?

DEEPSEEK

The relative credibility of **Hamas versus the Palestinian National Authority (PNA)** as representatives for Gaza is a complex issue shaped by governance, public opinion, and geopolitical dynamics. Here's a breakdown of the key factors:

1. Governance and Control

- **Hamas:**
 - Has ruled Gaza since 2007, providing services (healthcare, education, policing) through its **Da'wa system** (social institutions) despite being a militant group.
 - Maintains **de facto authority** even during war, with intact command structures despite Israeli decimation of its leadership.
 - Seen as **resisting Israeli occupation**, which resonates with many Palestinians.
- **PNA:**
 - Lacks control over Gaza since 2007 and is widely viewed as **corrupt, ineffective, and subservient to Israel** due to security coordination.
 - Its governance in the West Bank is **eroding**, with Israel revoking its planning powers in parts of Area B (2024).

Verdict: Hamas has **operational credibility** in Gaza; the PNA is seen as absentee or compromised.

2. Public Opinion

- **Hamas:**
 - Support has **declined** since October 2023 due to war devastation, but it remains more popular than the PNA in Gaza.
 - Only **40% of Gazans** support the PNA's return to govern Gaza post-war, while a **plurality still expect Hamas to retain control**.
 - Hamas is credited with "**placing Palestine on the global agenda**" post-October 7, despite opposition to its methods.
- **PNA:**
 - **81% of Palestinians** want President Mahmoud Abbas to resign.
 - **Fatah (PNA's party) trails Hamas in popularity**, even in the West Bank.

Verdict: Hamas retains **symbolic legitimacy** as a resistance force, while the PNA is broadly discredited.

3. Geopolitical Backing

- **Hammas:**
 - Backed by **Iran and Qatar**, but facing unprecedented pressure from Arab states (e.g., Saudi Arabia, Egypt) to disarm.
 - Rejects disarmament, framing armed resistance as a "**national right**".
- **PNA:**
 - Recognized internationally (e.g., by Ireland, France) as the **legitimate representative** of Palestine, but lacks grassroots support.
 - Promoted by **Saudi Arabia and the West** as the "lesser evil," but seen as a **puppet of foreign interests** by many Palestinians.

Verdict: The PNA has **diplomatic legitimacy**, but Hammas has **street credibility**.

4. The Credibility Paradox

- **Hammas's strength:**
 - **Perceived defiance** against Israel outweighs its governance failures for many Palestinians.
 - Its **ideological roots** (e.g., rejection of Oslo, commitment to "liberation") resonate more than the PNA's pragmatism.
- **PNA's weakness:**
 - **No elections since 2006** (Hammas won the last vote).
 - **No resistance narrative:** Seen as collaborating with Israel's occupation.

Verdict: Hammas's **anti-occupation stance** grants it moral authority, while the PNA's **compliance** undermines its legitimacy.

Conclusion

While the PNA is the **internationally preferred** interlocutor, Hammas holds **greater credibility in Gaza** due to:

1. **Actual control** (governance, social services).
2. **Resistance narrative** (vs. PNA's perceived subservience).
3. **Public sentiment** (distrust of PNA, grudging respect for Hammas's defiance).

However, Hammas's credibility is **fragile**—waning support due to war suffering and Arab pressure to disarm could shift dynamics. For now, **neither faction fully represents Gaza's interests**, leaving a vacuum that fuels the cycle of conflict.

PROMPTER

How does according PNA effective representation by recognising a State of Palestine in 2024 reflect on the situation in Gaza? What can be practically or ideologically inferred for Gaza from it?

DEEPSEEK

The recognition of the **Palestinian National Authority (PNA)** as the representative of a **State of Palestine** in 2024 carries **symbolic weight** but has **limited practical impact** on Gaza's governance or humanitarian crisis. Here's how this recognition reflects on Gaza's situation and what can be inferred from it:

1. Symbolic vs. Practical Authority in Gaza

- **PNA's Lack of Control in Gaza:** Since 2007, Hammas has governed Gaza, while the PNA's authority is confined to parts of the West Bank. Recognition

does **not** restore the PNA's control over Gaza, nor does it alter Hamas's de facto rule.

- **Diplomatic Fiction:** Recognition treats the PNA as the legitimate government of **all** Palestinian territories (Gaza, West Bank, East Jerusalem), despite its absence in Gaza. This creates a **legal contradiction**—acknowledging a state whose government cannot enforce sovereignty in half its claimed territory.

Inference: Recognition is a **political statement** against Hamas's rule but does little to dismantle it.

2. Implications for Gaza's Future Governance

- **International Pressure on Hamas:** Countries like France, the UK, and Australia tie recognition to demands that Hamas **disarm and cede power** to the PNA. However, Hamas rejects this, insisting armed resistance is a "national right".
- **Saudi Arabia's Role:** Riyadh is pushing a plan to transfer Gaza's governance to the PNA, backed by Arab states and Western recognition. Yet, without Israeli cooperation or Hamas's surrender, this remains theoretical.

Inference: Recognition aims to **isolate Hamas ideologically** but lacks enforcement mechanisms.

3. Humanitarian and Legitimacy Paradox

- **Moral Leverage:** Recognition amplifies calls to end Gaza's humanitarian crisis by framing Israel's actions as violations of a **sovereign state's territory** (e.g., ICJ rulings on occupation).
- **PNA's Credibility Gap:** The PNA is widely seen as corrupt and ineffective. Polls show **only 17% of Gazans** want it to govern post-war, compared to 37% for Hamas.

Inference: Recognition risks **legitimizing a weak PNA** while failing to address Gaza's immediate needs.

4. Geopolitical Divides and Israeli Reactions

- **Israel's Rejection:** Netanyahu argues recognition "rewards terrorism" and undermines hostage negotiations. Israel's planned reoccupation of Gaza further negates Palestinian sovereignty claims.
- **US/EU Split:** The US opposes recognition, while European states use it to pressure Israel. This divide **weakens cohesive action** on Gaza.

Inference: Recognition fuels diplomatic tensions but doesn't halt Israel's military actions.

5. Ideological Shifts

- **Two-State Reinforcement:** Recognition keeps the **1967 borders** as the baseline for negotiations, countering Israel's annexation of Palestinian land.
- **Hamas's Narrative:** Hamas frames recognition as a victory for its "resistance," though it rejects the PNA's legitimacy.

Inference: The move **preserves the two-state ideal** but deepens the Hamas-PNA rivalry.

Conclusion: A Symbolic Gesture with Limited Reach

- **Practically:** Recognition changes little in Gaza without PNA reinstatement, Hamas's disarmament, or Israeli withdrawal.
- **Ideologically:** It isolates Hamas internationally but **fails to unite Palestinians** under a credible leadership.

Key Takeaway: The recognition of Palestine in 2024 is a **diplomatic tool** to shape future negotiations, not a solution for Gaza's governance or suffering.

PROMPTER

It seems Gaza falls through the crack here? Recognising PNA could be thought of as disregarding what might be credible as representative of Gaza (however disliked by dominant political alignments) and imposing what has no credible representation of Gaza (however amenable to dominant political alignments). Is that a reasonable inference?

DEEPSEEK

Yes, that is a **reasonable and analytically sharp inference**. The act of recognizing the PNA as the representative of the **State of Palestine**—while Gaza remains under Hamas control—creates a **fundamental contradiction**: it imposes a political structure (the PNA) that lacks credibility or authority in Gaza, while disregarding the entity (Hamas) that *does* govern Gaza, albeit controversially.

Why This Is a "Crack" Gaza Falls Through

1. The PNA's Lack of Legitimacy in Gaza

- The PNA has not governed Gaza since 2007 and is widely seen as **corrupt, collaborationist, and detached** from Gazans' realities.
- Polls show **only 17% of Gazans** want the PNA to return post-war, while **37% still prefer Hamas** despite its devastating war with Israel.
- The PNA's **security coordination with Israel** (e.g., arresting Hamas sympathizers in the West Bank) further erodes its credibility.

2. Hamas's De Facto Rule, Despite Being a Pariah

- Hamas provides **governance (however authoritarian) and social services** in Gaza, whereas the PNA does nothing.
- Many Gazans see Hamas as the only faction that **resists Israeli occupation**, even if they criticize its governance.
- By excluding Hamas, recognition **artificially pretends Gaza is part of a PNA-led state**, when in reality, it is a **separate political entity**.

3. International Hypocrisy

- Western and Arab states recognize the PNA **not because it represents Palestinians effectively**, but because:
 - It is **non-violent** (unlike Hamas).
 - It accepts the **two-state solution** (unlike Hamas's rejectionist stance).
 - It is **willing to cooperate with Israel** (unlike Hamas).
- This makes recognition a **top-down imposition** rather than an organic reflection of Palestinian political realities.

What Can Be Inferred?

- **Diplomatic Convenience Over Representation:** Recognition prioritizes **international diplomatic consensus** over actual Palestinian political dynamics.
- **Gaza's Political Erasure:** The move **sidelines Gaza's governance reality**, treating it as a "problem" to be solved by PNA reinstatement rather than engaging with its actual power structures.
- **Long-Term Instability Risk:** If the PNA cannot govern Gaza (and Hamas won't surrender), recognition may **deepen the West Bank-Gaza divide**, making a unified Palestinian state even less likely.

Is This Deliberate?

Some argue that recognition is **strategic**:

- It **denies Hamas legitimacy** while keeping the two-state solution alive.
- It **pressures Israel** by framing Gaza as "occupied Palestinian land," even if the PNA doesn't control it.

But the **gap between legal fiction and reality** remains stark.

Final Verdict: Yes, recognition of the PNA **disregards Gaza's actual governance** in favor of a politically palatable (but practically weak) alternative. Whether this is a **necessary compromise** or a **fatal flaw** in the peace process depends on whether Hamas can be sidelined—or whether Gaza's realities must eventually be confronted.

PROMPTER

Is it possible that if Israel annexes Gaza, as it appears set to do, it can still be argued that the formal recognition of a State of Palestine holds insofar as PNA exists (in howsoever fractured and diluted a form)? It can still be argued that a two-state solution is symbolically out there?

DEEPSEEK

Yes, even if Israel annexes Gaza, the **formal recognition of a State of Palestine** could still be argued to hold **symbolically and legally**—but with severe practical and political contradictions. Here's how this paradoxical scenario might unfold:

1. Legal vs. Factual Sovereignty

- **Recognition as a Legal Fiction:**
International recognition of Palestine (e.g., by Ireland, France, the UK) is based on the **1967 borders**, irrespective of Israel's de facto control. The PNA's existence in parts of the West Bank allows states to treat it as the government of a sovereign entity, even if its authority is fractured.
 - **Precedent:** States recognize governments-in-exile (e.g., Tibet's) despite occupation. Similarly, Palestine's UN observer state status (since 2012) persists despite Israeli annexation efforts.
- **Annexation's Illegality:**
The ICJ's 2024 advisory opinion ruled Israel's occupation (including potential Gaza annexation) **illegal under international law**, reinforcing Palestine's *de jure* sovereignty claims.

2. The PNA's Role as a Placeholder

- **Symbolic Governance:**

The PNA remains the internationally recognized Palestinian government, even if it:

- Lacks control over Gaza (Hamas-ruled since 2007).
- Has eroding authority in the West Bank (Israel revoked its planning powers in Area B in 2024).
- Is widely viewed as corrupt and illegitimate by Palestinians.

- **Diplomatic Utility:**

States use the PNA to:

- Sustain the **two-state narrative** (e.g., UK/France's 2025 recognition conditioned on PNA-led governance).
- Isolate Hamas and counter Israel's annexation with legal counterclaims.

3. The Two-State Solution's Symbolic Survival

- **Political Theater vs. Reality:**

- **Proponents** (EU, Arab states) argue recognition keeps the two-state framework alive, pressuring Israel to eventually negotiate.
- **Critics** (Israel, US) call it empty symbolism, noting Gaza/West Bank disunity and PNA's weakness.

- **The "State of Palestine" as a Diplomatic Tool:**

Recognition allows:

- ICC prosecutions (e.g., war crimes in "occupied Palestine").
- UN resolutions condemning annexation (e.g., 2025 Security Council debates).

4. Contradictions and Challenges

- **Gaza's Erasure:**

Annexation would render the two-state solution **geographically impossible** (no contiguous Palestine). States might still recognize Palestine *in principle* but lack leverage to enforce it.

- **PNA's Collapse Risk:**

If Israel dismantles the PNA (e.g., by expanding Area C control), recognition becomes purely notional—like recognizing a government with no territory.

- **Hamas's Shadow:**

Gaza's governance by Hamas (rejected by the West) undermines the PNA's claim to represent "Palestine" holistically.

Conclusion: A Fading Mirage?

Recognition of Palestine can persist **symbolically** post-annexation, but its practical meaning erodes as:

1. Israel physically absorbs Palestinian land.
2. The PNA becomes a hollow shell.
3. The world lacks collective will to enforce sovereignty (e.g., sanctions on Israel).

Bottom Line: The two-state solution survives **on paper** as a diplomatic protest against annexation, but its viability hinges on reversing Israeli facts on the ground—a distant prospect without US/EU muscle.

PROMPTER

Is Israel's hostility to recognising the State of Palestine, which extends to PNA, and deliberately conflating that with rewarding Hamas, understandable as essentially a rejection of any two-state solution? How else can it be understood?

DEEPSEEK

Israel's hostility toward recognizing the **State of Palestine**—and its deliberate conflation of the **Palestinian National Authority (PNA)** with **Hamas**—can indeed be understood as a **de facto rejection of the two-state solution**, but it also reflects deeper ideological, security, and political calculations. Here's a breakdown of the motivations and alternative interpretations:

1. Rejection of the Two-State Solution

- **Netanyahu's Explicit Opposition:**
 - Netanyahu has repeatedly stated that a Palestinian state would be a **"launch pad to annihilate Israel"** and insists it would **"reward terror"** after Hamas's October 7 attacks.
 - His government has accelerated **West Bank settlement expansion** and proposed **indefinite military control over Gaza**, making territorial partition impossible.
- **Settler Influence:**
 - The Israeli far-right, including ministers like **Ben-Gvir and Smotrich**, views the West Bank as **"Judea and Samaria"**—biblical Jewish land—and rejects any withdrawal.
 - Over **700,000 settlers** now live in occupied territories, creating irreversible facts on the ground.
- **Legal Annexation by Stealth:**
 - Israel's revocation of PNA authority in parts of **Area B (2024)** and its **de facto annexation of East Jerusalem** signal an intent to **absorb Palestinian territories** rather than permit statehood.

2. Conflating the PNA with Hamas: A Strategic Smear

- **Undermining Palestinian Legitimacy:**
 - By equating the **PNA (Fatah-led)** with **Hamas**, Israel dismisses **all Palestinian governance** as inherently violent or untrustworthy, despite the PNA's **security coordination with Israel** and recognition of Israel's right to exist.
 - This narrative allows Israel to argue that **no "partner for peace" exists**, justifying perpetual occupation.
- **Exploiting Western Fears:**
 - Framing recognition as a **"reward for Hamas"** resonates with Western governments wary of Islamist militancy, even though states like France

and the UK explicitly condition recognition on **Hamas disarming** and the PNA reforming.

3. Alternative Explanations

A. Security Paranoia

- **Trauma of October 7:**
 - Israel fears a repeat of Hamas's attack from any future Palestinian state, especially if Gaza and the West Bank unify. This drives insistence on **demilitarization** and **Israeli security control**—terms Palestinians reject as neo-colonial.

B. Political Survival

- **Netanyahu's Coalition:**
 - His government depends on far-right parties that **threaten to collapse** if he concedes statehood. Annexation rhetoric consolidates their base.

C. One-State Reality

- **"Greater Israel" Ambitions:**
 - Some factions in Israel prefer a **single state** (with Palestinian disenfranchisement) over partition. By blocking statehood, they advance this goal.

4. International Reactions

- **Diplomatic Isolation:**
 - Israel's stance has alienated even traditional allies (e.g., France, UK, Canada), who now see recognition as a **tool to pressure Israel** into negotiations.
- **ICJ/UN Condemnation:**
 - The 2024 ICJ ruling against Israel's occupation underscores that its position violates international law, further isolating it.

Conclusion: A Multilayered Rejection

Israel's hostility to Palestinian statehood is **primarily ideological** (rejecting partition) but also **strategic** (avoiding concessions) and **political** (appeasing settlers). The conflation of the PNA with Hamas is a **deliberate tactic** to delegitimize all Palestinian governance.

Alternative interpretations:

1. **Security maximalism:** Israel won't accept statehood without ironclad guarantees.
2. **Negotiation sabotage:** Prolonging statelessness strengthens Israel's bargaining position.
3. **Demographic fear:** A Palestinian state could demand refugee returns, threatening Israel's Jewish majority.

Ultimately, Israel's stance signals that the two-state solution **exists only rhetorically**—while its actions ensure its impossibility.

PROMPTER

Has Ireland maintained trade relations with Israel in 2024 and 2025?

DEEPSEEK

Yes, Ireland has **maintained trade relations with Israel in 2024 and 2025**, despite its strong diplomatic criticisms of Israel's actions in Gaza and its recognition of the State of Palestine. Here's a breakdown of the trade dynamics and political tensions:

1. Trade Volume (2024–2025)

- **2024 Imports from Israel:** €3.8 billion, primarily in **electrical machinery, scientific apparatus, and chemicals**.
- **2024 Exports to Israel:** Not specified in the data, but Ireland is Israel's **largest EU trading partner** for imports.
- **2025 Trends:** Trade continues, though Ireland is advancing a bill to ban commerce with **Israeli settlements** in occupied territories (discussed below).

2. Political Context

- **Recognition of Palestine (May 2024):** Ireland joined Spain and Norway in recognizing Palestine, prompting Israel to **close its Dublin embassy**.
- **Condemnation of Israeli Actions:** Ireland has:
 - Supported ICJ cases against Israel's occupation.
 - Called for EU sanctions and a review of the **EU-Israel Association Agreement**.
- **Criticism of Trade Continuity:** Pro-Palestinian groups and academics argue Ireland's trade undermines its moral stance.

3. Legislative Moves to Restrict Trade

- **Occupied Territories Bill (2025):** Would ban trade with Israeli settlements, but faces delays due to EU legal concerns.
 - Symbolic impact: Trade with settlements is minimal (<€1 million annually) 3.
- **Calls for Full Embargo:** Some Irish politicians and scholars demand a **complete trade embargo**, citing Israel's "genocidal" actions in Gaza.

4. EU Constraints

- **Trade Policy:** Ireland cannot unilaterally restrict trade (an EU competence) but pushes for bloc-wide measures.
- **Hypocrisy Charge:** Despite rhetoric, Ireland (like other EU states) profits from Israeli trade (e.g., €3.58 billion in integrated circuit imports in 2023).

Conclusion

Ireland **continues trading with Israel** while leading diplomatic efforts against its policies. The disconnect between **moral condemnation and economic ties** mirrors broader EU inertia. Pending legislation targets settlements, but a full rupture remains unlikely without EU consensus.

Of related interest: [Perspective of Mahmoud Abbas, President of Palestine](#)